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Data Architect - Buildings

Data Technical Lead

Ministry of Housing, Communities and Local Government

Apply before 11:55 pm on Tuesday 22nd September 2026



Reference number

480160

Salary

£60,230 - £65,820

The basic pay for this role will be between £65,820 - £74,413 (London), £60,230 - £68,705 (National). A digital allowance may also be payable depending on the level of assessed capability, in order to meet the MHCLG

overall targeted remuneration rate for the specific grade, location and capability rating.

A Civil Service Pension with an employer contribution of 28.97%

Job grade

Grade 7

Contract type

Permanent

Type of role

Digital

Working pattern

Flexible working, Full-time, Job share, Part-time

Number of jobs available

1

Contents

Location

About the job

Benefits

Things you need to know

Apply and further information

Location

Bristol, Darlington, London, Manchester, Wolverhampton

About the job

Job summary

We are MHCLG

We are looking for a motivated Data Architect to support MHCLG's digital and data transformation across the built environment system, with a particular focus on building data and digital architecture. You will sit within the Building Insights division and be key to the development of a new Strategic Digital and Data Hub, leading work to define and embed a clear, consistent approach to how building data is structured, managed and used across a complex and rapidly expanding portfolio of digital services.

Working across multiple programmes, you will play an important role in ensuring data is treated as a core asset, supporting effective regulation and enabling a more joined-up, data-driven system. This is an exciting opportunity to shape how building data underpins a modern regulatory system, setting clear policy, standards and expectations for how data is defined, shared and maintained.

You will operate at the intersection of policy, data and digital delivery, leading work to establish a coherent approach to building data across the system. A central part of the role will be providing technical expertise to inform digital strategy, system design and governance, ensuring policy and delivery decisions are grounded in a strong understanding of digital and data structures, standards and lifecycle management. You will identify and define common digital components and patterns for open, interoperable data, helping to reduce fragmentation and promote consistency across services. You will lead the development of policy and design for cross-service data flows and data lifecycle, setting clear expectations for how building data is created, validated, stored, shared and maintained over time.

You will also contribute to shaping requirements for key data initiatives (including the Golden Thread), ensuring that policy clearly sets out the intended outcomes, standards and information needs, while working with digital and delivery teams to translate these into practical implementation. Working closely with digital and policy colleagues, you will ensure that approaches to digital projects across building safety are technically robust,

implementable and aligned with wider system design. You will support governance by ensuring data considerations, standards and definitions are clearly embedded in decision-making and assurance processes.

Find out more about our Digital teams and what they are working on through our [MHCLG Digital blog](#). **Please note that MHCLG do not offer visa sponsorship and applicants will need a valid visa for the duration of your employment.**

Job description

This role brings together technical digital leadership, policy development and cross-portfolio coordination. As a Data Architect, you'll:

- Lead the development of building open data policy, including data flows, lifecycle, standards and interoperability across the portfolio

- Provide technical data expertise to inform digital strategy and governance, ensuring alignment between policy, architecture and delivery

- Identify and define common data patterns, components and reusable structures, promoting consistency and reducing duplication across services

- Develop policy for data flows across organisational and system boundaries, enabling effective and secure data sharing

- Define policy requirements for key data initiatives, ensuring clarity on outcomes, standards and technical requirements such as APIs (including for the Golden Thread)

- Work closely with digital and policy teams to ensure policies are grounded in delivery and can be implemented in practice

- Support governance processes, ensuring data standards, definitions and lifecycle expectations are consistently applied

- Provide clear, expert advice and briefings on data issues, translating technical concepts into actionable insight

- Build and influence relationships across MHCLG and with external stakeholders, supporting alignment on data policy and standards.

- Monitor developments in digital and data approaches within the built environment, to identify opportunities and risks

Person specification

As a Data Architect, you'll have:

Experience being a confident and collaborative specialist, comfortable operating in a complex and evolving environment

Strong experience of working with data in a policy, digital or technical context, with a clear understanding of how data underpins service delivery and regulatory outcomes

Ability to lead technical policy development, applying structured thinking to complex data challenges, and working with multidisciplinary digital teams to translate policy into implementable approaches

Comfortability taking a system-wide view of data, identifying opportunities for standardisation, reuse and improved data flows across organisational boundaries.

Experience leading or shaping open data policy, data standards or digital architecture in a complex environment

Strong technical understanding of data structures, digital architecture, working with APIs, data interoperability, data flows and lifecycle management

Experience working across programmes or portfolios with multiple systems, teams and dependencies

The ability to apply technical digital and data expertise to strategic decision-making and digital system design

Experience providing clear, high-quality advice and briefings on complex data issues

Strong collaboration and influencing skills, particularly across technical and non-technical stakeholders

Benefits

Alongside your salary of £60,230, Ministry of Housing, Communities and Local Government contributes £17,448 towards you being a member of the Civil Service Defined Benefit Pension scheme. [Find out what benefits a Civil Service Pension provides \(opens in a new window\).](#)

At MHCLG we offer many benefits that range from tailored career pathways and flexible working to MyLifestyle Childcare Voucher and Cycle to Work Schemes. For more information, please click [here](#).

Things you need to know

Artificial intelligence

Artificial intelligence can be a useful tool to support your application, however, all examples and statements provided must be truthful, factually accurate and taken directly from your own experience. Where plagiarism has been identified (presenting the ideas and experiences of others, or generated by artificial intelligence, as your own) applications may be withdrawn and internal candidates may be subject to disciplinary action. Please see our [candidate guidance \(opens in a new window\)](#) for more information on appropriate and inappropriate use.

Selection process details

Application and Selection

The application process will be split into 2 stages, testing the following Success Profiles:

Behaviours , **Experience** , **Strengths** , **Technical**

Please ensure your CV does not contain any personally identifiable information.

Note: We do not consider direct CV applications. All applications must be submitted via the provided application link.

Stage 1: Sift (CV)

Experience: Your CV will be assessed using the Experience success profile.

Most of our campaigns utilise multiple assessors and so it is possible that each of your answers would be viewed by different assessors.

In the event that we receive a large number of applications, we may conduct an initial sift using the lead sift question listed in the advert. Candidates who pass the initial sift may be progressed to a full sift, or progressed straight to interview.

Lead sift question (Technical): Please describe how you would approach communicating data requirements and making data decisions with technical and non-technical stakeholders.

Stage 2: Short Interview (30 minutes)

Technical: Candidates who are successful at sift will be asked to attend a short 30-minute interview and deliver a technical presentation. Candidates who pass this stage will be invited to a full interview.

Stage 2: Interview

Behaviours: Working Together, Seeing the Bigger Picture, Communicating and Influencing

Strengths: The strength-based questions will require natural responses from the candidates.

Sift and Interview Dates

Sifting is envisaged to take place from 23rd September 2026.

Interviews are envisaged to take place shortly after and are currently being held remotely via videocall. This could be subject to change.

Group 1 Digital & Data Roles

MHCLG has implemented the Digital and Data capability framework for Group 1 roles. Applicants that are successful and have been offered a

position will be required to complete a capability assessment after the interview.

MHCLG will honour completed capability assessments for this role from other Government Departments for existing civil servants on level transfer only. Please provide a copy of your capability assessment to the Hiring Manager when applying. If you have any queries on pay, please contact the Hiring Manager.

Each experience or technical skill is assessed between 1-3, representing working towards, at or above the job level requirements. You are awarded a proficiency level accordingly, and you will be given opportunity to annually re assess your capability and potentially increase your overall remuneration, through payment of allowances, depending on level of assessed capability.

Candidates moving from another government department have the option to retain their current basic pay if this is within our pay band for the relevant grade.

Grade 7 Group 1 Digital and Data salary

The basic pay for this role will be between £65,820 - £74,413 (London), £60,230 - £68,705(National). Candidates will usually be recruited to the median of the payscale.

A digital allowance may also be payable depending on the level of assessed capability, in order to meet the MHCLG overall targeted remuneration rate for the specific grade, location and capability rating.

For applicants in receipt of existing allowances, we will assess each case individually, but we would seek not to exceed the MHCLG overall targeted remuneration rate for the specific grade, location and capability rating for existing civil servants, the usual policy on level transfer and promotion will apply, subject to the statements above.

How We Recruit

Find out everything you need to know before applying here..

Applying

Sifting

Interview

Interview Results & Feedback

Reserve List

Near Miss

Civil Service Grades

We are a DCS, RIS & GPTWV employer

Reasonable Adjustments

Human

How to Apply

What you need to know before applying.

Security Clearance Requirements

Civil Service Nationality Requirements

Right to Work

Artificial Intelligence

Civil Service Code and Recruitment Principles

CV Declaration

Sponsorships

Salary and Grade

Existing Civil Servants

Conflict of Interest

Location and Flexible Working

Fixed Term Contracts

Internal Fraud Database - Internal Fraud Register

Appeals and Complaints

Conflict of Interest

Security Clearance Requirements

National Office: BPSS + SC

London Office: BPSS + SC

Feedback will only be provided if you attend an interview or assessment.

Security

Successful candidates must undergo a basic (or equivalent) criminal record check.

Successful candidates must meet the security requirements before they can be appointed. The level of security needed is [security check \(opens in a new window\)](#).

[See our vetting charter \(opens in a new window\)](#).

People working with government assets must complete [baseline personnel security standard \(opens in new window\)](#) checks.

Nationality requirements

This job is broadly open to the following groups:

UK nationals

nationals of the Republic of Ireland

nationals of Commonwealth countries who have the right to work in the UK

nationals of the EU, Switzerland, Norway, Iceland or Liechtenstein and family members of those nationalities with settled or pre-settled status

under the [European Union Settlement Scheme \(EUSS\) \(opens in a new window\)](#)

nationals of the EU, Switzerland, Norway, Iceland or Liechtenstein and family members of those nationalities who have made a valid application for settled or pre-settled status under the European Union Settlement Scheme (EUSS)

individuals with limited leave to remain or indefinite leave to remain who were eligible to apply for EUSS on or before 31 December 2020

Turkish nationals, and certain family members of Turkish nationals, who have accrued the right to work in the Civil Service

[Further information on nationality requirements \(opens in a new window\)](#)

Working for the Civil Service

The [Civil Service Code \(opens in a new window\)](#) sets out the standards of behaviour expected of civil servants.

We recruit by merit on the basis of fair and open competition, as outlined in the Civil Service Commission's [recruitment principles \(opens in a new window\)](#).

The Civil Service embraces diversity and promotes equal opportunities. As such, we run a Disability Confident Scheme (DCS) for candidates with disabilities who meet the minimum selection criteria.

The Civil Service also offers a Redeployment Interview Scheme to civil servants who are at risk of redundancy, and who meet the minimum requirements for the advertised vacancy.

Diversity and Inclusion

The Civil Service is committed to attract, retain and invest in talent wherever it is found. To learn more please see the [Civil Service People Plan \(opens in a new window\)](#) and the [Civil Service Diversity and Inclusion Strategy \(opens in a new window\)](#).

Apply and further information

Once this job has closed, the job advert will no longer be available. You may want to save a copy for your records.

Contact point for applicants

Job contact :

Name : Digital Data Jobs

Email : Digitaldatajobs@communities.gov.uk

Recruitment team

Email : Digitaldatajobs@communities.gov.uk

Further information

If you are unsure about any part of the process or require additional information about the post to enable you to progress your application, you should speak to the Resourcing team - Recruitment@communities.gov.uk. Candidates can appeal at any stage of the recruitment process if they believe there has been:

- a procedural irregularity

- an infringement of the Civil Service equal opportunities policy

- exceptional circumstances which were not notified to the interview panel

which might have affected performance on the day.

It is important to note that these are appeals about the process not the decision. In the first instance, an appeal should be directed to the MHCLG Resourcing Hub at Recruitment@communities.gov.uk.

If the MHCLG Resourcing Hub is unable to satisfactorily resolve your complaint, you may contact put your complaint in writing to the Civil Service Commission, Room G8,1 Horse Guards Road, London, SW1A 2HQ or by email to: info@csc.gov.uk

